



▲ SPENCER CARBINE MODEL 1865

Date 1865

Origin US

Barrel 20in (51cm)

Caliber .50in

For this lever-action model, gunmaker Christopher Spencer amended the design of his original repeating rifle and carbine to eliminate minor faults. This 1865 carbine had six-groove rifling. It was also made under contract by the Burnside Rifle Company. The gun carried a tubular magazine in its butt. Some other guns of the time carried another common magazine type—the box form, in which cartridges were stacked one above the other.



▲ WINCHESTER MODEL 1866 CARBINE

Date 1866

Origin US

Barrel 23in (58.5cm)

Caliber .44in rim-fire

The principal shortcoming of the Henry Model 1860 (left) lay in the way its tubular magazine was charged. In 1866, an improvement was introduced to allow reloading via a port on the receiver, which doubled the rifle's rate of fire to 30 rounds a minute. The ammunition used by this rifle and the Model 1860 was a rim-fire cartridge in which the projectile and propellant were contained in the cartridge case and the primer was carried in its rim (see p.112).



▲ LE MAT REVOLVER RIFLE

Date 1872

Origin France/US

Barrel 24¾in (62.8cm)

Caliber .44in and .66in

Based on a similar pistol, the Le Mat Revolver Rifle was an oddity. It boasted two barrels; the lower, charged with shot, acted as the axis pin for the nine-chambered cylinder, which was charged with ball cartridges. The gun was equipped with a loading/ejection gate and rod, similar to those found on Colt's early brass-cartridge pistols.



◀ WINCHESTER MODEL 1876

Date 1876

Origin US

Barrel 28in (71cm)

Caliber .45in

Popular with frontier hunters, this lever-action model was designed to take a powerful .45in-75 caliber cartridge. In total, it took four types of high-powered cartridges reaching up to .50in-95 Express—a powerful cartridge with high-velocity propellant. Manufacturers had begun to use precise caliber designations for their cartridges—.50in is the caliber and 95 refers to the weight of charge in grains.



▲ VETTERLI-VITALI 1880

Date 1880

Origin Italy

Barrel 34in (86cm)

Caliber 10mm

The Vetterli-Vitali 1880 was an experimental bolt-action rifle fitted with a tubular magazine and was an adaptation of earlier single-shot Italian rifles. Vetterli-Vitali eventually became better known for its box magazine system, which was introduced in 1886.